

Getting a job

When applying for and interviewing for a job, a strong cover letter and a clear resume can make an employer take notice.

Finding vacancies

Finding a vacancy can seem like a job in itself, but there are lots of ways to go about it. Jobs are typically advertised in newspapers, on recruitment and company websites, and on social media. Networking to gather contacts in companies, by talking to people face-to-face or online, is a great way to get noticed, as is volunteering and work experience or internships.



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Use social media to your advantage by researching employers and searching for vacancies. You can also build and promote your own professional online brand, but be careful about what you post—potential employers might see it.

◀ How to search

Newspapers, websites, and job search apps are invaluable when job hunting.

Applying for a role

Most applications consist of a cover letter and a resume. A job description tells an applicant the sort of skills an employer wants. Knowing this allows the applicant to think about what skills they have—such as communication, teamwork, or adaptability—and how these are suited to the role for hire.

▽ Good preparation

Tailoring the resume and cover letter to the job and thoroughly checking the spelling and grammar of both will improve a person's chances.

A cover letter should include:

- contact information—name, address, email, and phone number
- an opening greeting and job reference number, if there is one
- the reason for the application and how a person's experience, knowledge, qualifications, and skills match the employer's requirements
- the reason why working for this company appeals
- a formal sign-off, such as "Sincerely" or "Best regards"

A resume should include:

- contact information—name, address, email, and phone number
- a personal profile with key points
- qualifications
- previous experience (employment, volunteering, and internships all count)
- skills
- achievements
- hobbies and interests